# Rongjie Zhang

Research Fellow · MIT Center for Real Estate · Massachusetts Institute of Technology
zhangrongjie@tsinghua.edu.cn | Google Scholar | Personal website

## Academic Appointments

**2026–present** Research Fellow, MIT Center for Real Estate, Massachusetts Institute of Technology

**2024–2026** Research Fellow, Institute of Real Estate and Urban Studies, National University of Singapore

## Education

**2024** Ph.D. in Engineering, Department of Civil Engineering, Tsinghua University

Outstanding Ph.D. Dissertation (top 5%); Excellent Graduate Award (top 1%); Rising Academic Star Award.

**2019** Bachelor of Engineering, Department of Construction Management, Tsinghua University

**2019** Second Bachelor's Degree in Economics (Dual-Degree Program), School of Economics and Management, Tsinghua University

Graduated with distinction; Excellent Graduate Award (top 1%).

## Research Interests

Real estate and urban economics; household behavior and human capital; labor and inequality; environmental economics and climate adaptation; local public finance and political economy.

## Journal Publications

1. **Corruption stereotype and the unintended consequences of an anti-corruption campaign: evidence from the real estate sector in China.** Hanming Fang and Rongjie Zhang. *Journal of Public Economics*, 249, 105474 (2025). *(co-corresponding author)*
2. **Unused housing in urban China and its carbon emission impact.** Hefan Zheng, Rongjie Zhang, Xinru Yin, and Jing Wu. *Nature Communications*, 16, 1985 (2025). *(co-corresponding author)*
3. **Caring about bequest, so caring for parents? Evidence from China's housing sector.** Jia He, Jing Wu, Qi Zhang, and Rongjie Zhang. *Real Estate Economics*, 52(6), 1446–1469 (2024). *(corresponding author)*
4. **The Aggregate and Distributional Impacts of Residence Policy Relaxation.** Rongsheng Tang, Yang Tang, and Rongjie Zhang. *Journal of Real Estate Finance and Economics*, 69(2), 343–376 (2024).
5. **Value of qualification to buy a house: Evidence from the housing purchase restriction policy in China.** Hefan Zheng, Rongjie Zhang, and Jing Wu. *Cities*, 135, 104197 (2023). *(corresponding author)*
6. **Land finance in China: Analysis and review.** Joseph Gyourko, Yang Shen, Jing Wu, and Rongjie Zhang. *China Economic Review*, 76, 101868 (2022). *(corresponding author)*
7. **Can Professional Football Players Adapt to Air Pollution? Evidence From China.** Yu Qin, Jing Wu, and Rongjie Zhang. *Journal of Sports Economics*, 23(3), 277–300 (2022). *(corresponding author)*
8. **Land Financing, Corporate Tax Subsidy, and Investment Attraction.** Rongjie Zhang, Weizeng Sun, Hao Li, and Jing Wu. *China Journal of Economics*, 8(4), 57–86 · In Chinese (2021).
9. **An Analysis of the Buyer Concentration in China's Residential Land Market: A Study Based on Big Data.** Jing Wu and Rongjie Zhang. *Journal of Jiangxi University of Finance and Economics*, 2020(1) · In Chinese (2020).

## Working Papers

1. **Migration Restrictions and the Migrant-Native Wage Gap: The Roles of Wage Setting and Sorting.** Naijia Guo, Li Zhang, Ben Zou, and Rongjie Zhang. *Revise & resubmit, American Economic Review.*
2. **When Protection Hurts: Labor Market Consequences of Mandatory Heat Allowances in China.** Sumit Agarwal, Kam C. Chan, Nianhang Xu, Ruoming Yang, and Rongjie Zhang. *Revise & resubmit, Journal of Environmental Economics and Management.*
3. **Sex Ratios and Competitive Human Capital Investment: Evidence from Housing Prices and Educational Expenditures.** Shang-Jin Wei, Jing Wu, and Rongjie Zhang.
4. **Intra-household Bargaining and Fertility Decision-making: Evidence from Homeownership Structure and Housing Price Shocks in China.** Boyuan Huang, Jing Wu, and Rongjie Zhang.
5. **Elite Platforms or Big Fish? Sorting, Human Capital Accumulation, and Returns to Top University Admission.** Rongjie Zhang and Wenlan Qian.
6. **Defending the Coasts: Seawalls, Typhoons, and Adapting to Sea-Level Rise.** Yichun Fan, Yuqi Song, and Rongjie Zhang.

## Teaching

**2022–2023** Teaching Assistant, Real Estate Investment (graduate), Tsinghua University.

Tsinghua University Excellent Teaching Assistant Award, 2022 (ranked sixth university-wide in the evaluation).

**2021–2023** Teaching Assistant, Real Estate Price Theories and Appraisal Techniques (undergraduate), Tsinghua University.

## Journal Referee Service

Applied Economics Letters; Canadian Journal of Economics; China Economic Review; Cities; Economic Analysis and Policy; Economic Inquiry; Economic Modelling; Habitat International; Heliyon; International Journal of Strategic Property Management; Journal of Contemporary Accounting and Economics; Journal of Cleaner Production; Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization; Journal of Housing and the Built Environment; Journal of Housing Economics; Journal of Real Estate Finance and Economics; Journal of Regional Economics; Journal of Sports Economics; Real Estate Economics; Regional Science and Urban Economics; Review of Development Economics; Scientific Reports; Sustainable Development; Urban Studies.

## Selected Conference and Seminar Presentations

**2027** American Real Estate and Urban Economics Association Annual Conference (scheduled)

**2026** Asian Bureau of Finance and Economic Research Annual Conference (Singapore); International Conference of China and Development Studies (Shanghai); China International Conference in Finance (Hong Kong); World Congress of Environmental and Resource Economics (Lisbon); Asian Real Estate Society–Global Chinese Real Estate Congress Joint International Real Estate Conference (Hangzhou); China Real Estate Academic Annual Conference (Xi'an)

**2025** American Real Estate and Urban Economics Association Annual Conference (San Francisco); Asian Bureau of Finance and Economic Research Annual Conference (Singapore); Asian Economic Development Conference (Beijing); Asian Real Estate Society International Real Estate Conference (Melbourne); Global Chinese Real Estate Congress International Real Estate Conference (Beijing); China Real Estate Academic Annual Conference (Chizhou); Jinan University–Singapore Management University Conference on Urban and Regional Economics (Guangzhou)

**2024** American Real Estate and Urban Economics Association Annual Conference (San Antonio); World Bank Land Conference (Washington, DC); Asian Economic Development Conference (Seoul); China Real Estate Academic Annual Conference (Wuhan); Renmin University of China–Global Labor Organization Annual Conference (Beijing); China Society of Urban Economy Annual Conference (Dali)

**2023** Asian Bureau of Finance and Economic Research Annual Conference (Singapore); American Real Estate and Urban Economics Association Annual Conference (Cambridge, UK); Asian Real Estate Society–Global Chinese Real Estate Congress Joint International Real Estate Conference (Hong Kong); Massachusetts Institute of Technology Asia Real Estate Initiative Inaugural Symposium (Boston); China Real Estate Academic Annual Conference (Hangzhou); Jinan University–Singapore Management University Conference on Urban and Regional Economics (Guangzhou)

**2022** Young Economist Society Annual Conference (Kunming)

**2021** China Real Estate Academic Annual Conference (Shanghai); Symposium on Political Economics from Spatial Perspective (Zhuhai)

**2020** Symposium on Chinese Economy (Beijing)

**2018** China Real Estate Academic Annual Conference (Guangzhou)

## Honors and Awards

**2026** Research Excellence Award, Asia-Pacific Journal of Risk and Insurance

**2025** Best Paper Award (First Prize), China Real Estate Academic Annual Conference

**2024** Outstanding Ph.D. Dissertation, Tsinghua University (top 5%)

**2024** Excellent Graduate, Tsinghua University (top 1%)

**2024** Rising Academic Star Award, Tsinghua University

**2024** Best Paper Award (First Prize), China Real Estate Academic Annual Conference

**2023** Jiang Nanxiang Scholarship, Tsinghua University

**2023** China National Scholarship

**2023** Best Paper Award (Second Prize), China Real Estate Academic Annual Conference

**2022** Excellent Teaching Assistant Award, Tsinghua University (ranked sixth university-wide)

**2022** Best Paper Award, 684th Ph.D. Student Forum, Tsinghua University

**2021** Best Paper Award (Second Prize), China Real Estate Academic Annual Conference

**2020** Outstanding Student Cadre Benchmark, Tsinghua University

**2019** Future Scholar Scholarship, Tsinghua University

**2019** Excellent Graduate, Tsinghua University (top 1%)